

March SSR Meeting #8

Tuesday, September 15, 2026

1:00pm – 3:00pm

BOCC Meeting Room

Zoom Link for Virtual Attendance

(In-person attendance requested)

Invite link: <https://us06web.zoom.us/j/88053660816?pwd=n7qJTXvayoEO5RY4eo8koGmh4nHHai.1>

Meeting ID: 880 5366 0816

Passcode: 616389

One tap mobile

+17193594580,,88053660816#,,,,*616389# US

+17207072699,,88053660816#,,,,*616389# US (Denver)

Join by SIP

• 88053660816@zoomcrc.com

Meeting Intent

During this meeting, we will review and discuss recommendations for changes to the Land Use Code that will make affordable and workforce housing easier to build. The feedback from this meeting will inform the final recommendations and redlines to the Land Use Code.

September SSR Meeting #8 Agenda

2-Hour Working Session

- I. Recap of prior meetings, draft code recommendations report, framing current discussion (*10 minutes*)
- II. Refine draft recommendations (*90 minutes*)
 - a) *Community Housing Zone:*
- III. Synthesis of feedback, key refinements, and areas needing follow-up (*15 minutes*)
- IV. Meeting wrap-up and next steps (*5 minutes*)

San Miguel County Housing Code Update

Project Summary

San Miguel County is undertaking a comprehensive land use code audit and update to identify and remove regulatory barriers that constrain housing development in unincorporated areas. The San Miguel County Housing Code Update, funded through Colorado's Proposition 123 Local Planning Capacity Grant, will assess current zoning regulations, development standards, and permitting processes to identify where unnecessary complexity, costs, or delays prevent housing production and adopt changes that help accelerate affordable housing production. This project implements key recommendations from the East End Master Plan and other community planning efforts. The goal of this project is to enable more housing choices while preserving community character.

July Stakeholder Strategic Roundtable (SSR) Summary

On Thursday, July 16 and July 27, the SSR met for three hours during both to review the Final Code Audit Report and refine density bonus recommendations for the LM, MD, and HD zone districts ahead of the July 29 joint BOCC/Planning Commission work session.

The group largely agreed that any new flexibility such as additional dwelling units, reduced setbacks, or increased density should be tied to deed-restricted workforce housing rather than market-rate development. The group discussed current barriers to building accessory dwelling units (ADUs), including construction cost, mitigation fees, and federal tax treatment of long-term rentals, and debated how density bonuses should be structured to avoid any issues with water availability and infrastructure capacity.

Items with SSR majority consensus:

- Allow multiple accessory dwelling units on large lots, provided the additional (bonus) unit is deed-restricted for workforce housing.
- Reduce side setbacks in Medium Density (MD) and High Density (HD) zones to 10'.
- Maintain by-right density at 1 DU/35 acres in Low Density (LD), Medium Density (MD) and High Density (HD) zones; increase density by one- and two-step review only through a workforce housing density bonus; require PUD for free-market development.

Topic previously discussed and majority consensus:

- Zoning and/or Density Adjustment
- Standards for Additional Workforce Housing Types
- Regulatory Incentives for Affordable Housing Development
- Options for Streamlined Application Procedures/Processes
- General Code Structure Enhancements

Topics Not Being Considered at This Time, but Potentially Eligible for Future Review Through the Housing Action Plan

- **Adjust minimum parking requirement for all residential development:** *not proven effective in other communities and would compound current issues further.*
- **Incorporate campers, RVs, and vans as a standalone or accessory housing use:** *not enough community support at this time.*
- **Provide application fee reductions or waivers:** *development fees are already low, plan inspection fee cannot be waived, and sales and use tax cannot be waived.*
- **Provide incentives for deed-restricted ADUs:** *determined not to be an effective tool at this time.*
- **Reductions in open space requirements:** *open space preservation is a community priority.*
- **Adjust/revise the employee housing mitigation impact fee structure:** *would require further discussion with the housing authority.*

- **Develop a TDR program and integrate affordable housing as an incentive:** *not feasible at this time as this is a lengthy process that would require extensive research and development.*
- **Consolidate residential zones intended for lower density:** *upon further investigation, it was determined that the each of the existing low-density districts have a district purpose and should not be combined.*

Pending Changes to Final Code Audit Report

- Incorporate all items with SSR majority consensus into the final report.
- Refine the density bonus program for LD, MD, and HD zones, including lot size and dwelling unit allowances tied to the percentage of units an applicant agrees to deed-restrict for the workforce.
- Add further clarification on tabled items that will inform future work, including a recommendation to update Section 5-13 for workforce housing needs outside the Telluride R-1 School District.

Add redlines updating references to “live-work” units in Section 5-319.2D.III and striking “by-right” in bulk standards.